Dr. Lara J. Martin

Assistant Professor, CSEE • University of Maryland, Baltimore County (UMBC)

Information Technology and Engineering (ITE) Building, Room 342-A

laramar@umbc.edu | laramartin.net

Google Scholar | Github | LinkedIn

Research Interests

Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Natural Language Processing/Generation, Neurosymbolic Methods for NLP, Computational Creativity, Automated Story Generation & Understanding, Tabletop Roleplaying Agents, Augmentative & Alternative Communication (AAC), Assistive Technologies (AT), Speech Processing, Affective Computing

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology — *Aug. 2015 - May 2021*

Ph.D. in Human-Centered Computing — *Atlanta, GA*

+ Advisor: Dr. Mark O. Riedl
+ Thesis: Neurosymbolic Automated Story Generation
+ Teaching Certification: Tech to Teaching (Summer 2018)

Carnegie Mellon University — *Aug. 2013 – May 2015*

M.S. in Language Technologies — *Pittsburgh, PA*

+ Advisor: Dr. Alan W Black

Rutgers University — New Brunswick — *Sep. 2009 – May 2013*

B.S. in Computer Science & Linguistics (double major) — *Piscataway, NJ*

+ Advisor: Dr. Matthew Stone

Research Experience

Assistant Professor — *Aug 2023 – Present*

University of Maryland, Baltimore County — *Baltimore, MD*

Computer Science and Electrical Engineering (CSEE) Department

Affiliate of the Information Systems Department

Computing Innovation Fellow (CIFellow) Postdoctoral Researcher — *Jan 2021 – Aug 2023*

University of Pennsylvania — *Philadelphia, PA*

Computer and Information Science Department

Graduate Research Assistant — *Aug 2015 – Dec 2020*

Georgia Institute of Technology — *Atlanta, GA*

School of Interactive Computing

Applied Scientist Intern — *May 2017 – Aug 2017*

Amazon.com Inc. — *Seattle, WA*

Alexa Smart Home Machine Learning

Graduate Research Assistant — *Sept 2013 – Aug 2015*

Carnegie Mellon University — *Pittsburgh, PA*

Language Technologies Institute

Intern, Virtual Patient Project — *May 2011 – Aug 2011*

University of Southern California — *Playa Vista, CA*

Institute for Creative Technologies

Teaching

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

CMSC 412/612 Neurosymbolic Text Generation

Fall 2026 – Instructor of Record, Permanent course version of Interactive Fiction & Text Generation

CMSC 473/673 Natural Language Processing

Spring 2026 – Instructor of Record, Hybrid course to include Shady Grove students

Spring 2025 – Instructor of Record

Spring 2024 – Instructor of Record

CMSC 491/691 Interactive Fiction and Text Generation

Fall 2025 – Instructor of Record

Fall 2024 – Instructor of Record

CMSC 671 Principles of Artificial Intelligence

Fall 2023 – Instructor of Record

University of Pennsylvania

CIS 700 Interactive Fiction and Text Generation

Spring 2022 – Co-Instructor, Co-taught with Dr. Chris Callison-Burch

Georgia Institute of Technology

Clarks Scholars Summer Python Bootcamp

Summer 2019 – Course Materials, Co-created syllabus/lesson plan with Dr. Cassandra Kent

CS 3790 Introduction to Cognitive Science

Summer 2018 – Instructor of Record

Projects

Human-AI Communication and Computational Creativity. Collaboration between people and AI, primarily through storytelling.

Story understanding	[6, 7, 20]	*2021 – Present*
D&D-Playing and Strategic Agents	[3, 4, 8, 15, 18, 19, 22]	*2018 – Present*
Story generation	[1, 9–12, 16, 17, 21, 23, 24, 33]	*2015 – Present*
Schemas	[5, 11, 12]	*2023*
Conversational agents	[28], See also: Amazon & USC ICT internships	*2011, 2017, 2022*
Language learning	[26]	*2014*

Human-Human Communication. Analysis of human-human communication or computer-mediated communication.

Augmentative and Alternative Communication (AAC)	[2, 32]	*2022 – Present*
Emotion recognition & affective computing	[2, 14, 29–31]	*2013 – Present*
Online communities	[7, 25]	*2014, 2023*
Translation	[13]	*2015*

Publications

PhD Dissertation

[1] **Lara J. Martin**. "Neurosymbolic Automated Story Generation". Doctoral dissertation. Georgia Institute of Technology, 2021. URL: http://hdl.handle.net/1853/64643.

Conference Proceedings

*equal contribution, † presented, Students advised or co-advised are underlined

[2] Shadab Choudhury†, Asha Kumar, and **Lara J. Martin**. "Evaluating Human-LLM Representation Alignment: A Case Study on Affective Sentence Generation for Augmentative and Alternative Communication". In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: IJCNLP-AACL 2025*. Mumbai, India: AFNLP & ACL, Dec. 2025, pp. 1618–1637. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2025.findings-ijcnlp.100. arXiv: 2503.11881. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2025.findings-ijcnlp.100/. [12% acceptance rate].

[3] Andrew Zhu†, **Lara J. Martin**†, Andrew Head, and Chris Callison-Burch. "CALYPSO: LLMs as Dungeon Master's Assistants". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE)*. Vol. 19. 1. Salt Lake City, UT: AAAI, Oct. 2023, pp. 380–390. DOI: 10.1609/aiide.v19i1.27534. arXiv: 2308.07540. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AIIDE/article/view/27534. [∼59% acceptance rate].

[4] Andrew Zhu†, Karmanya Aggarwal, Alexander Feng, **Lara J. Martin**, and Chris Callison-Burch. "FIREBALL: A Dataset of Dungeons and Dragons Actual-Play with Structured Game State Information". In: *Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. Vol. 1: Long Papers. Toronto, Canada: ACL, July 2023, pp. 4171–4193. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2023.acl-long.229. arXiv: 2305.01528. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2023.acl-long.229/. [23.5% acceptance rate].

[5] Tianyi Zhang*†, Isaac Tham*, Zhaoyi Hou*, Jiaxuan Ren, Liyang Zhou, Hainiu Xu, Li Zhang, **Lara J. Martin**, Rotem Dror, Sha Li, Heng Ji, Martha Palmer, Susan Brown, Reece Suchocki, and Chris Callison-Burch. "Human-in-the-Loop Schema Induction". In: *Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. Vol. 3: System Demonstrations. Toronto, Canada: ACL, July 2023, pp. 1–10. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2023.acl-demo.1. arXiv: 2302.13048. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2023.acl-demo.1/. [37% acceptance rate].

[6] Yijiang River Dong, **Lara J. Martin**, and Chris Callison-Burch. "CoRRPUS: Code-based Structured Prompting for Neurosymbolic Story Understanding". In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2023*. Toronto, Canada: ACL, July 2023, pp. 13152–13168. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2023.findings-acl.832. arXiv: 2212.10754. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2023.findings-acl.832/. [18.4% acceptance rate].

[7] Salvatore Giorgi, Ke Zhao, Alexander H. Feng, and **Lara J. Martin**†. "Author as Character and Narrator: Deconstructing Personal Narratives from the *r/AmITheAsshole* Reddit Community". In: *International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)*. Vol. 17. 1. Limassol, Cyprus: AAAI, June 2023, pp. 233–244. DOI: 10.1609/icwsm.v17i1.22141. arXiv: 2301.08104. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/22141. [∼20% acceptance rate].

[8] Chris Callison-Burch*, Gaurav Singh Tomar*†, **Lara J. Martin**, Daphne Ippolito, Suma Bailis, and David Reitter. "Dungeons and Dragons as a Dialogue Challenge for Artificial Intelligence". In: *Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates: ACL, Dec. 2022, pp. 9379–9393. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2022.emnlp-main.637. arXiv: 2210.07109. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2022.emnlp-main.637. [22.1% acceptance rate].

[9] Prithviraj Ammanabrolu†, Ethan Tien, Wesley Cheung, Zhaochen Luo, William Ma, **Lara J. Martin**†, and Mark O. Riedl. "Story Realization: Expanding Plot Events into Sentences". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)*. Vol. 34. 5. New York, NY: AAAI, Apr. 2020, pp. 7375–7382. DOI: 10.1609/aaai.v34i05.6232. arXiv: 1909.03480. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org//index.php/AAAI/article/view/6232. [20.6% acceptance rate].

[10] Pradyumna Tambwekar*, Murtaza Dhuliawala*†, **Lara J. Martin**†, Animesh Mehta, Brent Harrison, and Mark O. Riedl. "Controllable Neural Story Plot Generation via Reward Shaping". In: *International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI)*. Macao, China, July 2019, pp. 5982–5988. DOI: 10.24963/ijcai.2019/829. arXiv: 1809.10736. URL: https://www.ijcai.org/proceedings/2019/829. [17.9% acceptance rate].

[11] **Lara J. Martin**†, Prithviraj Ammanabrolu, Xinyu Wang, William Hancock, Shruti Singh, Brent Harrison, and Mark O. Riedl. "Event Representations for Automated Story Generation with Deep Neural Nets". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)*. Vol. 32. 1. New Orleans, LA: AAAI, Feb. 2018, pp. 868–875. ISBN: 978-1-57735-800-8. DOI: 10.1609/aaai.v32i1.11430. arXiv: 1706.01331. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/11430. [24.6% acceptance rate].

[12] **Lara J. Martin**†, Brent Harrison, and Mark O. Riedl. "Improvisational Computational Storytelling in Open Worlds". In: *International Conference on Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS)*. Ed. by F. Nack and A.S. Gordon. Vol. 10045. Lecture Notes in Computer Science (LNCS). Los Angeles, CA: Springer, Oct. 2016, pp. 73–84. ISBN: 978-3-319-48278-1. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-319-48279-8_7. URL: https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-48279-8_7. [36% acceptance rate].

[13] **Lara J. Martin**†, Andrew Wilkinson†, Sai Sumanth Miryala, Vivian Robison, and Alan W Black. "Utterance Classification in Speech-to-Speech Translation for Zero-Resource Languages in the Hospital Administration Domain". In: *2015 IEEE Workshop on Automatic Speech Recognition and Understanding (ASRU)*. Scottsdale, AZ: IEEE, Dec. 2015, pp. 303–309. DOI: 10.1109/ASRU.2015.7404809. URL: https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/7404809. [47.8% acceptance rate].

[14] **Lara J. Martin**†, Matthew Stone, Florian Metze, and Jack Mostow. "A Methodology for Using Crowdsourced Data to Measure Uncertainty in Natural Speech". In: *2014 IEEE Spoken Language Technology Workshop (SLT)*. South Lake Tahoe, NV: IEEE, Dec. 2014, pp. 95–99. DOI: 10.1109/SLT.2014.7078556. URL: https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/7078556. [48.6% acceptance rate].

Peer-Reviewed Workshop Papers

*equal contribution, †presented, Students advised or co-advised are underlined

[15] Patty Delafuente†, Arya Honraopatil†, and **Lara J. Martin**. "Does Reasoning Help LLM Agents Play Dungeons and Dragons? A Prompt Engineering Experiment". In: *EMNLP 2025 Fifth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Suzhou, China, Nov. 2025. arXiv: 2510.18112. URL: https://wordplay-workshop.github.io/pdfs/29.pdf.

[16] Runsheng "Anson" Huang†, **Lara J. Martin**, and Chris Callison-Burch. "WHAT-IF: Exploring Branching Narratives by Meta-Prompting Large Language Models". In: *EMNLP 2025 Fifth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Suzhou, China, Nov. 2025. arXiv: 2412.10582. URL: https://wordplay-workshop.github.io/pdfs/4.pdf.

[17] Rachel Chambers†, Naomi Tack, Eliot Pearson, **Lara J. Martin**, and Francis Ferraro. "BERALL: Generating Retrieval-augmented State-based Interactive Fiction Games". In: *ACL 2024 Fourth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Bangkok, Thailand, Aug. 2024. URL: https://wordplay-workshop.github.io/wordplay2024/pdfs/21.pdf.

[18] Chris Callison-Burch*†, Gaurav Singh Tomar*, **Lara J. Martin**, Daphne Ippolito, Suma Bailis, and David Reitter. "Dungeons and Dragons as a Dialogue Challenge for Artificial Intelligence". In: *NAACL 2022 Third Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Virtual/Seattle, WA, July 2022. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=EKwH-BMlkzq.

[19] Stefan Papazov†, Wesley Gill, Marta Garcia Ferreiro, Andrew Zhu, **Lara J. Martin**, and Chris Callison-Burch. "Using Language Models to Convert Between Natural Language and Game Commands". In: *NAACL 2022 Third Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Virtual/Seattle, WA, July 2022. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=jQSStHwtmDN.

[20] Bryan Li†, **Lara J. Martin**, and Chris Callison-Burch. "CIS^2: A Simplified Commonsense Inference Evaluation for Story Prose". In: *ACL 2022 Workshop on Commonsense Representation and Reasoning (CSRR)*. Virtual/Dublin, Ireland, Mar. 2022. arXiv: 2202.07880. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=Se-xHMYg_bc.

[21] Prithviraj Ammanabrolu†, Ethan Tien, Wesley Cheung, Zhaochen Luo, William Ma, **Lara J. Martin**, and Mark O. Riedl. "Guided Neural Language Generation for Automated Storytelling". In: *ACL 2019 Second Workshop on Storytelling (StoryNLP)*. Florence, Italy: ACL, Aug. 2019, pp. 46–55. DOI: 10.18653/v1/W19-3405. URL: https://aclanthology.org/W19-3405/.

[22] **Lara J. Martin**†, Srijan Sood, and Mark O. Riedl. "Dungeons and DQNs: Toward Reinforcement Learning Agents that Play Tabletop Roleplaying Games". In: *Joint AIIDE Workshop on Intelligent Narrative Technologies and Workshop on Intelligent Cinematography and Editing (INT-WICED)*. Ed. by Hui-Yin Wu, Mei Si, and Arnav Jhala. Edmonton, AB, Canada: http://ceur-ws.org, Nov. 2018. URL: http://ceur-ws.org/Vol-2321/paper4.pdf.

[23] **Lara J. Martin**†, Prithviraj Ammanabrolu, Xinyu Wang, Shruti Singh, Brent Harrison, Murtaza Dhuliawala, Pradyumna Tambwekar, Animesh Mehta, Richa Arora, Nathan Dass, Chris Purdy, and Mark O. Riedl. "Improvisational Storytelling Agents". In: *NeurIPS 2017 Workshop on Machine Learning for Creativity and Design*. Long Beach, CA, Dec. 2017. URL: https://nips2017creativity.github.io/doc/Improvisational_Agents.pdf.

[24] **Lara J. Martin**†, Prithviraj Ammanabrolu, William Hancock, Shruti Singh, Brent Harrison, and Mark O. Riedl. "Event Representations for Automated Story Generation with Deep Neural Nets". In: *KDD 2017 Workshop on Machine Learning for Creativity*. Halifax, NS, Canada, Aug. 2017. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.01331v2. [38% acceptance rate].

[25] Seungwhan Moon†, Saloni Potdar, and **Lara J. Martin**. "Identifying Student Leaders from MOOC Discussion Forums through Language Influence". In: *EMNLP 2014 Workshop on Analysis of Large Scale Social Interaction in MOOCs*. Doha, Qatar, Oct. 2014, pp. 15–20. DOI: 10.3115/v1/W14-4103. URL: https://www.aclweb.org/anthology/W14-4103/.

[26] Nikolas Wolfe†, Vinay Vyas Vemuri, **Lara J. Martin**†, Florian Metze, and Alan W Black. "Applause: A Learning Tool for Low-Resource Languages". In: *CHI 2014 Designing Speech and Language Interactions Workshop (DSLI)*. Toronto, ON, Canada, Apr. 2014. URL: http://www.cs.toronto.edu/dsli2014/submissions/applause-chi-paper-photo-ready.pdf.

Preprints

[32] **Lara J. Martin** and Malathy Nagalakshmi. *Aging Up AAC: An Introspection on Augmentative and Alternative Communication Applications for Autistic Adults*. Apr. 2024. arXiv: 2404.17730. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.17730.

[33] Amal Alabdulkarim, Winston Li, **Lara J. Martin**, and Mark O. Riedl. *Goal-Directed Story Generation: Augmenting Generative Language Models with Reinforcement Learning*. Dec. 2021. arXiv: 2112.08593. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2112.08593.

Student Publications

[34] Arya Honraopatil. "Cooperative Roleplaying with Affective, Symbolic Representation-Guided Deep Reinforcement Learning". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE): Doctoral Consortium*. Belo Horizonte, MG, Brazil, Nov. 2026.

Other Publications

[27] Arya Honraopatil†, Sai Vallurupalli, and **Lara J. Martin**. "Shaping Perception of Emotional Storytelling with Synthesized Speech". In: *Mid-Atlantic Student Colloquium on AI, Language, and Learning (MASC-ALL)*. State College, PA, USA, Apr. 2025.

[28] Artemis Panagopoulou, Manni Arora, Li Zhang, Dimitri Cugini, Weiqiu You, Yue Yang, Liyang Zhou, Yuxuan Wang, Zhaoyi Hou, Alyssa Hwang, **Lara J. Martin**, Sherry Shi, Chris Callison-Burch, and Mark Yatskar. "QuakerBot: A Household Dialog System Powered by Large Language Models". In: *1st Alexa Prize TaskBot (Alexa Prize 2021)*. May 2022. URL: https://www.amazon.science/alexa-prize/proceedings/quakerbot-a-household-dialog-system-powered-by-large-language-models.

[29] Shoou-I Yu, Lu Jiang, Zhongwen Xu, Zhenzhong Lan, Shicheng Xu, Xiaojun Chang, Xuanchong Li, Zexi Mao, Chuang Gan, Yajie Miao, Xingzhong Du, Yang Cai, **Lara J. Martin**, Nikolas Wolfe, Anurag Kumar, Huan Li, Ming Lin, Zhigang Ma, Yi Yang, Deyu Meng, Shiguang Shan, Pinar Duygulu Sahin, Susanne Burger, Florian Metze, Rita Singh, Bhiksha Raj, Teruko Mitamura, Richard Stern, and Alexander Hauptmann. "CMU informedia@TrecVID 2015 MED/SIN/LNK/SED". In: *TREC Video Retrieval Evaluation 2015*. Gaithersburg, MD, Nov. 2015. URL: https://research.monash.edu/en/publications/cmu-informediatrecvid-2015-medsinlnksed.

[30] Shoou-I Yu, Lu Jiang, Zexi Mao, Xiaojun Chang, Xingzhong Du, Chuang Gan, Zhenzhong Lan, Zhongwen Xu, Xuanchong Li, Yang Cai, Anurag Kumar, Yajie Miao, **Lara J. Martin**, Nikolas Wolfe, Shicheng Xu, Huan Li, Ming Lin, Zhigang Ma, Yi Yang, Deyu Meng, Shiguang Shan, Pinar Duygulu Sahin, Susanne Burger, Florian Metze, Rita Singh, Bhiksha Raj, Teruko Mitamura, Richard Stern, and Alexander Hauptmann. "Informedia@TRECVID 2014 MED and MER". In: *TRECVID Video Retrieval Evaluation Workshop, NIST*. Gaithersburg, MD, Nov. 2014. URL: https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/citations/AD1024376.

[31] Sarah Cosentino†, Susanne Burger, **Lara J. Martin**, Florian Metze, Tatsuhiro Kishi, Kenji Hashimoto, Salvatore Sessa, Massimiliano Zecca, and Atsuo Takanishi. "A multisensory non-invasive system for laughter analysis". In: *36th Annual International Conference of the IEEE Engineering in Medicine and Biology Society (EMBC)*. Chicago, IL, Aug. 2014. URL: https://laramartin.net/pub/EMBC14-Laughter.pdf.

Grants and Awards

Grants

University of Maryland, Baltimore, Institute for Clinical & Translational Research (ICTR) - CEnR Partnership Development Voucher Award — *2026 – 2027*
"Robotically-Supported Augmentative and Alternative Communication" — **$10,000**
Lara J. Martin (Co-PI, Lead), Cynthia Matuszek (Co-PI), Jason Falvey (UMB Co-PI) — *UMBC*

Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) — *2025 – 2026*
"DC-Baltimore AAAI AIxAccessibility Event" — **$1,000**
Lara J. Martin (Co-Organizer, Lead), Abraham Glasser (Co-Organizer), Foad Hamidi (Co-Organizer), Stephanie Valencia Valencia (Co-Organizer) — *UMBC*

UMBC COEIT Interdisciplinary Proposals — *2024 – 2025*
"Investigating the Social and Affective Aspects of Large-Language Model-based Augmentative and Alternative Communication Systems" — **$20,000**
Foad Hamidi (Co-PI), Lara J. Martin (Co-PI) — *UMBC*

UMBC Summer Research Faculty Fellowship (SuRFF) — *2024*
"Reinforcement Learning for Playing Dungeons & Dragons" — **$8,000**
Lara J. Martin — *UMBC*

National Science Foundation & Computing Research Association — *2021 – 2023*
(NSF 2030859) Computing Innovation Postdoctoral Fellowship — **$200,000**
Lara J. Martin (Postdoc), Chris Callison-Burch (Faculty Mentor) — *University of Pennsylvania*

Awards

UMBC Department of Accessibility & Disability Services — *2026/2027*
UMBC Accessibility Trailblazer Award Honorable Mention
Annual award for faculty and departments to be recognized for their commitment to making accessible materials and fostering inclusion across campus.

James D. Foley GVU Center Endowment, Georgia Institute of Technology *2019*
FOLEY SCHOLAR AWARD **$5,000**
Every year, three PhD students across Georgia Tech's College of Computing are selected from a group of around 8 finalists to receive the prestigious Foley Scholarship in recognition for their efforts in innovative research.

🏛 Institutional and Departmental Service

INSTITUTIONAL

Note: COEIT stands for the College of Engineering and Information Technology.

Open-Source Data and AI Tools for Community Organizations Workshop Series *August 31, 2026*
LECTURER FOR SESSION 5: LARGE LANGUAGE MODELS AND EFFECTIVE PROMPTING PRACTICES *UMBC*

Faculty Development Center – New Faculty Welcome Panel *August 17, 2026*
PANELIST *UMBC*

GSA's Graduate Experiences, Achievements and Research Successes (GEARS) Research Symposium *April 7, 2026*
JUDGE *UMBC*

COEIT Admitted Student Sneak Peek *February 20, 2026*
VOLUNTEER & LECTURER *UMBC*
Mock Lecture on "AI for Interactive Fiction and Automated Story Generation"

Redefine Excellence in Research and Creative Achievement Subgroup for UMBC's Strategic Planning *Spring 2026*
COMMITTEE MEMBER *UMBC*

Barry Goldwater Scholarship & Excellence in Education Foundation *Fall 2025 – Present*
COMMITTEE MEMBER *UMBC*

Language Technology Seminar Series (LaTeSS) *Fall 2024 – Present*
CREATOR & ORGANIZER *UMBC*

ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing *September 10-12, 2025*
UMBC REPRESENTATIVE

COEIT Research Day *Spring 2025*
WORKING GROUP MEMBER *UMBC*

Faculty Senate's Ad Hoc Committee on AI Integration in the Classroom *Fall 2024 – Spring 2025*
COMMITTEE MEMBER *UMBC*

Teaching about LLMs to Faculty Learning Committees (FLCs) *Fall 2023 – Spring 2024*
VOLUNTEER *UMBC*
Teaching in the era of AI FLC (11/17/2023, 4/19/2024)
AI in the Classroom FLC (12/8/2023)

DEPARTMENTAL

COEIT Admitted Student Sneak Peek *March 26-27, 2026*
VOLUNTEER *UMBC*
Mock Lecture on "AI for Interactive Fiction and Automated Story Generation"

Computer Science AI/ML Undergrad Track Director *Fall 2025 – Present*
UMBC, CSEE

Inclusive Excellence Committee *Spring 2025 – Present*
CO-FOUNDER, COMMITTEE MEMBER *UMBC, CSEE*

Department Library Liaison *Fall 2024 – Present*
UMBC, CSEE

Graduate Admissions Committee — *Fall 2023 – Present*
Committee Member — *UMBC, CSEE*

Undergraduate CS Academic Advisor — *Fall 2023 – Fall 2025*
UMBC, CSEE

Professional Service

Summary

11	**Leadership Positions**
13	**Area Chair/Senior Area Chair Positions**
4	**Grant Reviewer**
40	**Program Committee Member/Reviewer, including Journal Reviewer**
68	**Total Participation**

Leadership Positions

Robots for All (Nonprofit) — *May 2026 – Present*
Research Expert

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *November 10-14, 2025*
Ethics Chair — *Edmonton, Canada*

5th Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at EMNLP 2025 — *November 9, 2025*
Co-Organizer — *Suzhou, China*

IEEE Transactions on Games: Special Issue on Large Language Models and Games — *May 2025*
Guest Editor

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *November 18-22, 2024*
Ethics & Conference Experience Chair — *Lexington, KY*

4th Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at ACL 2024 — *August 16, 2024*
Co-Organizer — *Bangkok, Thailand*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 11-15, 2021*
Doctoral Consortium Chair — *Virtual*

3rd Workshop on Narrative Understanding at NAACL 2021 — *June 11, 2021*
Co-Organizer — *Virtual*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 19-23, 2020*
Publicity Co-Chair — *Virtual*

1st Workshop on Narrative Understanding, Storylines, and Events (NUSE) at ACL 2020 — *July 9, 2020*
Co-Organizer — *Virtual*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 8-12, 2019*
Local Arrangements Chair — *Altanta, GA*

Other Chair Positions

International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG) — *October 29-November 2, 2025*
Area Chair — *Hanoi, Vietnam*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 8-12, 2023*
Session Chair — *Salt Lake City, UT*

International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG) — *September 11-15, 2023*
Area Chair — *Prague, Czechia*

International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG) — *September 20-24, 2021*
Area Chair — *Aberdeen, UK*

International Conference for Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS) — *December 5-8, 2018*
Associate Program Chair – Technologies Track — *Dublin, Ireland*

Grant Reviewer

2025 **National Science Foundation (IIS)**

2025 **Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft**

2025 **National Science Foundation**

2022 **Army Research Office**

Journal Reviewer

2026 **JMIR AI**

2024 **IEEE Transactions on Games**

2023 **IEEE Transactions on Games**

2021 **Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems (Springer)**

2020 **IEEE Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing**

2020 **ACM Computing Surveys (CSUR)**

ACL Rolling Review

March 2026 **Senior Area Chair** *– ACL 2026*

May 2025 **Senior Area Chair** *– EMNLP 2025*

March 2025 **Reviewer** *– ACL 2025*

February 2024 **Area Chair** *– ACL 2024*

December 2023 **Area Chair** *– NAACL 2024*

October 2023 **Area Chair** *– EACL 2024*

August 2023 **Area Chair**

April 2023 **Area Chair**

December 2022 **Area Chair**

October 2022 **Reviewer**

July 2022 **Reviewer**

April 2022 **Reviewer**

January 2022 **Reviewer**

Program Committee Member (Reviewer)

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE)	*November 9-13, 2026* *Belo Horizonte, MG, Brazil*
International Workshop on Computational Models of Narrative (CMN)	*June 8-10, 2026* *Madrid, Spain*
ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing	*April 13-17, 2026* *Barcelona, Spain*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE)	*November 10-14, 2025* *Edmonton, Canada*
5th Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at EMNLP 2025	*November 9, 2025* *Suzhou, China*

Computational Models of Narrative Workshop	*May 28-30, 2025* *Geneva, Switzerland*
AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES)	*October 20-22, 2025* *Madrid, Spain*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Doctoral Consortium	*November 18-22, 2024* *Lexington, KY*
International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG)	*September 23-27, 2024* *Tokyo, Japan*
Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play (CHI PLAY)	*October 14-17, 2024* *Tampere, Finland*
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) Student Research Workshop	*August 11-16, 2024* *Bangkok, Thailand*
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) Undergraduate Consortium	*February 20-27, 2024* *Vancouver, Canada*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Research Track – **Best Reviewer Nominee**	*October 8-12, 2023* *Salt Lake City, UT*
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) Student Research Workshop	*July 10-12, 2023* *Toronto, Canada*
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP) Dialogue and Interactive Systems Track	*December 7-11, 2022* *Abu Dhabi, UAE*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Software Track	*October 24-28, 2022* *Pomona, CA*
ACM Conference on Creativity & Cognition (C&C) Posters Track	*June 20-23, 2022* *Venice, Italy*
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)	*February 22-March 1, 2022* *Virtual*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Research Track	*October 11-15, 2021* *Virtual*
IEEE Conference on Games (CoG) Narrative and Interactive Entertainment Short Papers	*August 17-20, 2021* *Copenhagen, Denmark/Virtual*
Interactive Narrative Technologies (INT) Workshop at AIIDE	*October 19-20, 2020* *Virtual*
Procedural Content Generation (PCG) Workshop at Foundations of Digital Games (FDG)	*September 14, 2020* *Bugibba, Malta*
International Conference for Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS) Human Factors	*November 19-23, 2019* *Little Cottonwood Canyon, UT*
Procedural Content Generation (PCG) Workshop at Foundations of Digital Games (FDG)	*August 26, 2019* *San Luis Obispo, CA*
Workshop on Storytelling at ACL	*August 1, 2019* *Florence, Italy*
Workshop on Narrative Understanding at NAACL	*June 7, 2019* *Minneapolis, MN*
Knowledge Extraction from Games (KEG) Workshop at AAAI	*January 27, 2019* *Honolulu, HI*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Artifact Evaluation	*November 13-17, 2018* *Alberta, Canada*
Workshop on Storytelling at NAACL-HLT	*June 5, 2018* *New Orleans, LA*

Invited Talks and Panels

Summary

7	**Special Conference Presentations**
15	**On-Campus Invited Speaker Presentations**
4	**Panels**
26	**Total Presentations**

Special Conference Presentations

"Unnaturally Aligned: Creating AI Agents that Work for and with People"
Library Technology Immersion Conference – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *September 16, 2026*
↦ **Keynote Speaker**

"Aging Up AAC: An Introspection on Augmentative and Alternative Communication Applications for Autistic Adults"
CCC Computing Futures Symposium – *Washington, D.C.* ..... *May 15-16, 2025*
CIFellows Symposium – *Washington, D.C.* ..... *May 13-14, 2025*

"Digital Bards: How Dungeons & Dragons will Make for Better AI"
NULab for Texts, Maps, and Networks Spring Conference at Northeastern University – *Boston, MA* ..... *April 21, 2023*
↦ **Keynote Speaker**

"Using Storytelling to Understand the Technological and Experiential Requirements of Interactive Improvisational Agents"
Tapia Doctoral Consortium – *San Diego, CA* ..... *September 18, 2019*
↦ **Winner of Best Doctoral Consortium Presentation Award**

"Secrets of Computer Science Revealed"
STARS Alliance Celebration – *Atlanta, GA* ..... *August 17, 2013*

"CS Outreach Amongst Piscataway Youth"
STARS Alliance Celebration – *Atlanta, GA* ..... *August 16, 2013*

Invited Speaker Presentations

"Leveraging Large Language Models (LLMs) to Create Personalized Augmentative and Alternative Communication Systems (AACs)"
University of Maryland, Baltimore County - COEIT Research Day – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *April 11, 2025*

"Bridging the Social & Technical Divide in Augmentative and Alternative Communication (AAC) Applications for Autistic Adults"
University of Maryland, Baltimore County - CSEE Research Day – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *May 3, 2024*

"Neurosymbolic AI or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Large Language Model"
Human Language Technology Center of Excellence (HLTCOE) – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *April 18, 2024*
University of Maryland, Baltimore County - HCC Group FIKA – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *March 4, 2024*
Johns Hopkins University – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *February 16, 2024*
University of Maryland, Baltimore County – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *February 27, 2023*
Drexel University – *Philadelphia, PA* ..... *February 15, 2023*

"Neurosymbolic Storytelling or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Large Language Model"
University of Maryland, College Park - CLIP Colloquium – *College Park, MD* ..... *October 4, 2023*

"Dungeons and Discourse: Using Computational Storytelling to Look at Natural Language Use"

University of Southern California - NL Seminar – *Los Angeles, CA/Virtual* ..... *May 22, 2022*
University of California, Santa Cruz - Computational Media Seminar – *Santa Cruz, CA/Virtual* ..... *November 29, 2021*
Georgia Institute of Technology - NLP Seminar – *Atlanta, GA/Virtual* ..... *September 11, 2020*
Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory – *Livermore, CA/Virtual* ..... *June 11, 2020*

"Dungeons and Discourse: Using Computational Storytelling & Speech to Look at Natural Language Use"

University of Pennsylvania - CLUNCH (Computational Linguistics Lunch) Seminar – *Philadelphia, PA/Virtual* *January 25, 2021*
University of Utah – *Salt Lake City, UT/Virtual* ..... *April 20, 2020*

"Using Storytelling to Understand the Technological and Experiential Requirements of Interactive Improvisational Agents"

Georgia Tech - GVU Brown Bag – *Atlanta, GA* ..... *January 23, 2020*

Panelist

STEM Research & Publication Faculty Panel *October 13, 2025*
University of Maryland, Baltimore County - AOK Library and Grad Student & Postdoctoral Development *Baltimore, MD*

Doctoral Consortium Advice Panel *October 9, 2023*
AIIDE Conference - Doctoral Consortium *Salt Lake City, UT*

Computer Science PhD Panel *February 11, 2023*
University of Pennsylvania - FemmeHacks *Philadelphia, PA*

Future of Language Research *February 20, 2020*
Georgia Institute of Technology - IPaT Thursday Think Tank *Atlanta, GA*

Advising Summary

4	**PhD Thesis Advisees**
6	**MS Thesis Advisees**
9	**Other PhD Advisees**
27	**Other MS Advisees**
11	**Undergrad Advisees**
57	**Total Advisees**

PhD Advising

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

Shadab Choudhury *Fall 2026 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Marcus McAllister *Spring 2025 – Present*
PhD Computer Science
Co-Advised with Dr. Cynthia Matuszek

Arya Honraopatil *Summer 2024 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Patty Delafuente *Spring 2024 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Masters Thesis Advising

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

Maria Antonette Vanya — *Summer 2026 – Present*
MS Computer Science
Co-Advised with Dr. Andrea Kleinsmith

Naren Sivakumar — *Spring 2024 – Spring 2025*
MS Computer Science → PhD at UMBC
Thesis: Emulating Rational Decisions with Traditional and Contemporary AI

Shadab Choudhury — *Spring 2024 – Spring 2025*
MS Computer Science
Thesis: Connecting Language and Emotion in Large Language Models for Human-AI Collaboration

University of Pennsylvania

River Yijang Dong — *Summer 2022 – Spring 2023*
BA Mathematics/MS Data Science → PhD at Oxford University
Thesis: COTTAGE: Coherent Text Adventure Games Generation

Anna Orosz — *Spring 2021 – Fall 2021*
MS Data Science → Machine Learning Engineer at LinkedIn
Thesis: Generating Text-based Adventure Games

Sri Sanjeevini Devi Ganni — *Fall 2020 – Spring 2021*
MS Data Science → SDE at Amazon
Thesis: Narratology and Fanfiction

Other Mentorship

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

Krish Mehta — *Spring 2026 – Present*
MS Computer Science

Maria Antonette Vanya — *Spring 2026 – Present*
MS Computer Science

Ray Groshan — *Fall 2025 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Paul Abili — *Summer 2025 – Spring 2026*
BS Computer Science

Venkata Sai Harsha Kothapalli — *Fall 2025*
MS Computer Science

Lahari Vuppalapati — *Fall 2025*
MS Computer Science

AJ Boyd — *Fall 2024 – Spring 2025*
BS Computer Science → Data Engineer at Visa

Asha Kumar — *Summer 2024 – Fall 2024*
PhD Human-Centered Computing

Dedeepya Palakurthi — *Fall 2024*
MPS Data Science → Software Engineer at CVS Health

Saksham Kumar Sharma
MS Computer Science — *Fall 2024*

Ashish Athimamula
MS Computer Science — *Fall 2024*

June Young
MS Computer Science — *Spring 2024 – Fall 2024*

Shawn Bray
PhD Computer Engineering — *Spring 2024 – Fall 2024*

Arya Honraopatil
MS Computer Science → PhD Student at UMBC — *Spring 2024*

Tori Saylor
BS Computer Science — *Spring 2024*

Runsheng "Anson" Huang
MS Data Science at UPenn → AI Engineer at Terrasoft — *Spring 2023 – Spring 2024*

Christopher Cui
MS Computer Science at Georgia Tech → PhD Student at UC San Diego — *Summer 2023 – Fall 2023*

Outreach

Anderson Hwang, Roshan Johnson, and Siddharth Movva
Frontier Technology Institute (formerly The Coding School) — *Summer 2026*

Mark McGovern
Out in Tech U's Mentorship Program — *Summer 2022*

University of Pennsylvania

Malathy Nagalakshmi
MS Computer and Information Science → SDE at Amazon — *Summer 2022 – Summer 2023*

Andrew Zhu
PhD Computer and Information Science — *Fall 2022 – Spring 2023*

Tianyi Zhang
MS Data Science — *Fall 2022*

Karmanya Aggarwal
MS Data Science → ML Scientist at Nabla Bio, Inc. — *Fall 2022*

Alexander Feng
MS Data Science → Research Data Scientist at Booz Allen Hamilton — *Summer 2022 – Fall 2022*

Manni Arora
MS Computer and Information Science → Software Engineer at Siri NL — *Summer 2022*

Pooja Dattatri
MS Computer and Information Science → Application Developer at the University of Pennsylvania — *Summer 2022*

Shifan "Tim" Dong
BS at Washington University in St. Louis → Software Developer at DRW — *Summer 2022*

Salvatore Giorgi
PhD Computer and Information Science — *Summer 2022*

Ke "Coco" Zhao
BA Cognitive Science & Computer Science → SDE at Amazon
Summer 2022

Bryan Li
PhD Computer and Information Science
Spring 2021 – Spring 2022

Georgia Institute of Technology

Siyan "Sylvia" Li
BS Computer Science → MS student at Stanford University
Spring 2020 – Fall 2020

Sruthi Sudhakar
BS Computer Science → PhD student at Columbia University
Spring 2020

Kimberly Caras
MS Computer Science → D&A Modeler at KPMG Digital Lighthouse
Spring 2020

Winston Li
BS Computer Science → Quantitative Research Engineer at Citadel
Fall 2019 – Fall 2020

Andrew Silva
PhD Computer Science
Fall 2019

Srijan Sood
MS Computer Science → Research Engineer at JP Morgan
Summer 2018 – Summer 2019

Jainesh Doshi
MS Computer Science → Machine Learning Engineer at JP Morgan
Spring 2019

Taha Merghani
MS Computer Science → AI & Deep Learning Engineer at Decooda
Summer 2018 – Fall 2018

Ethan Tien
BS Computer Science → CS MS student at Georgia Tech
Spring 2018

Prithviraj Ammanabrolu
BS Computer Science → CS PhD student at Georgia Tech
Spring 2017 – Spring 2018

Pradyumna Tambwekar
MS Computer Science → CS PhD student at Georgia Tech
Spring 2017 – Spring 2018

Richa Arora
MS Computer Science → Google Analytics
Spring 2017 – Spring 2018

Xinyu "Lily" Wang
MS Computer Science → MS Language Technologies student at Carnegie Mellon
Spring 2017 – Spring 2018

Nathan Dass
BS Computer Science → MS student at Stanford University
Spring 2017 – Fall 2017

Murtaza Dhuliawala
MS Computer Science → Research Software Engineer at IBM Research
Spring 2017

Koustuv Saha
PhD Computer Science
Fall 2016

Yuval Pinter
PhD Computer Science
Fall 2016

Shruti Singh
MS Computer Science → Software Development Engineer at Amazon
Spring 2016 – Fall 2016

Will Hancock
MS Computer Science → PhD student at Northwestern University
Spring 2016 – Fall 2016

Thesis Committee Member

PhD

Defense Date / Advisor

Raguvir S ..... *Expected 2027*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Charles Nicholas*

Alabi Jamiu Ahmed ..... *Expected 2027*
PhD Information Systems at UMBC — *Dr. Vandana Janeja*

Yuxuan Jiang ..... *Expected 2027*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Frank Ferraro*

Shubhashis Roy Dipta ..... *Expected 2027*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Frank Ferraro*

Tung Duong Ta ..... *Expected 2027*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Tim Oates*

Sai Vallurupalli ..... *Expected 2027*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Frank Ferraro*

Michael Majurski ..... *Expected 2026*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Cynthia Matuszek*

Amal Alabdulkarim ..... *Expected 2026*
PhD Computer Science at Georgia Institute of Technology — *Dr. Mark Riedl*

Shahin Hossain ..... *April 22, 2026*
PhD Language, Literacy, and Culture at UMBC — *Dr. Ramon Goings*

Masters

Defense Date / Advisor

An May ..... *March 27, 2026*
MS Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Cynthia Matuszek*

Kaoru Seki ..... *November 5, 2025*
MS Human-Centered Computing at UMBC — *Dr. Yasmine Kotturi*

Santiago Góngora ..... *August 11, 2025*
MS Computer Science at Universidad de la República, Uruguay — *Dr. Luis Chiruzzo*

Ekele Ogbadu ..... *April 26, 2024*
MS Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Cynthia Matuszek*

Career Development

Fall 2025 – Spring 2026 **Faculty Learning Committee on *Designing Humanizing Assignments in the Age of AI***

January 2026 **University of Washington Book Club for *Disabling Intelligences: Legacies of Eugenics and How We are Wrong about AI***

Summer 2024 **NCFDD Faculty Success Program**

Conference Attendance

September 10-12, 2025 **CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing**

May 15-16, 2025	**CCC Computing Futures Symposium**
May 13-14, 2025	**CIFellows 2025 Symposium**
February 20-23, 2024	**CRA Career Mentoring Workshops (CMW)**
September 18-21, 2019	**ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing**
April 15-16, 2016	**CRA-Women Graduate Cohort Workshop**
October 2-5, 2013	**Anita Borg Institute's Grace Hopper Celebration**
August 16-17, 2013	**CRA STARS Alliance Celebration**

Media Coverage

Jul 11, 2025	**"Interactive Storytelling with AI – Dr. Lara Martin"** Jacob & Warren Tingen	*Tingenuity AI (podcast)*
Aug 19, 2023	**"Hallucinating ChatGPT finds a role playing Dungeons & Dragons"** Thomas Claburn	*The Register*
Fall 2022	**"Next-Gen Innovators: Penn Engineering Postdoctoral Fellows Lead the Way on Groundbreaking Research"** Amy Biemiller	*Penn Engineering Magazine*
Autumn 2021	**"Lara Martin: "How can I get a system to tell a story about anything I want?""** Masoud Golsorkhi	*TANK Magazine, Issue 88 (Narrative)*
Mar 15, 2021	**"Lara Martin on teaching AI to tell stories"** Amy Barrett	*BBC Science Focus Podcast*
Feb 17, 2021	**"Alexa, tell me a story"** Amy Barrett	*BBC Science Focus Magazine*
Apr 16, 2020	**"Meet ML@GT: Lara J. Martin Trains AI Agents to Become Storytellers"** Allie McFadden	*Georgia Tech Machine Learning, Memos from MLGT*
Feb 28, 2020	**"Forget Chess—the Real Challenge Is Teaching AI to Play D&D"** Will Knight	*Wired*
Feb 4, 2020	**"Changing the Conversation: Georgia Tech Researchers Provide New Approach to Automated Story Generation"** David Mitchell	*Georgia Tech School of Interactive Computing*
Feb 6, 2019	**"Pictionary-Playing AI Sketches the Future of Human-Machine Collaborations" (mention)** Eliza Strickland	*IEEE Spectrum*
Feb 2, 2018	**"Georgia Tech Artificial Intelligence Research Includes Collaborative Approaches with Humans, Automating Content, and More"** Joshua Preston	*Georgia Tech GVU Center*